

CRITICAL THINKING IN BUSINESS

Strategic Minds in a VUCA World

Full-Day Workshop · 7 Hours Active Training · 10–15 Participants

Most organisations do not have a shortage of smart people. They have a shortage of people who think rigorously under pressure. In VUCA environments, intuition misfire, confirmation bias, and groupthink cause capable teams to solve the wrong problems, miss early warning signals, and repeat the same decision errors. This workshop addresses that directly.

THINK SHARPER

Question assumptions before acting on them. Recognise System 1 traps and activate System 2 when it matters.

DECIDE BETTER

Apply structured frameworks to diagnose problems at their root, evaluate arguments with precision, and build sound reasoning under pressure.

LEAD DIFFERENTLY

Use Socratic questioning to unlock team thinking. Build cultures where challenging assumptions is the norm, not the exception.

This is not a passive learning day. Participants work with real cases, argue positions they disagree with, and leave with tools they can use the following Monday.

THE NUMBERS

The cost of poor thinking is not abstract. It is embedded in every strategy that missed the real problem, every decision made on bad assumptions, every team that agreed too easily.

- 85% of C-suite executives agree their organisations are bad at problem diagnosis — and 87% say it carries significant costs (HBR, Wedell-Wedellsborg, 2017)
- Teams with high collective intelligence are defined not by individual IQ, but by communication quality and turn-taking (Woolley et al., Science, 2010)
- Most domain experts are no better than informed laypeople at predicting complex outcomes — and often worse due to overconfidence (Tetlock, 2005)

For organisations, weak reasoning is a structural risk.

- Groupthink is most dangerous in high-performing teams — where trust reduces the perceived cost of dissent
- Confirmation bias is not fixed by more data — it is fixed by changing how you look at data
- The pre-mortem technique (Kahneman) surfaces hidden reservations before commitment — not after failure

Critical thinking is not a personality trait. It is a learnable, practicable skill. Today is the proof of that.

THE PROGRAM

Seven modules. Equal parts theory and application. Every module includes a structured exercise using participants' real business context.

01	Foundations	System 1 vs. System 2 thinking. Strong-sense vs. weak-sense critical thinking. The Snap Judgement Test.
02	R.E.D. Model & Biases	Recognise, Evaluate, Draw. Overconfidence, groupthink, and confirmation bias in business decisions.
03	Problem Diagnosis	The 5 Whys. Reframing vs. solving. Why 85% of organisations fix the wrong problem. The Slow Elevator.
04	Paul-Elder Framework	Eight elements of reasoning. Nine intellectual standards. The Square Tyre stress-test exercise.
05	First Principles	Analogy vs. first-principles thinking. The SpaceX case. Deconstructing a corporate process from scratch.
06	Socratic Collaboration	The HiPPO effect. Delphi method. Six Socratic question types. Socratic Speed Dating exercise.
07	Integrative Thinking	Holding opposing ideas. Pre-mortems. Unpopular Opinions debate. Individual action planning.

Format: Full-day, 7 hours. 50% theory, 50% applied exercises and role-play.

Group size: 10–15 participants. Adaptable with co-facilitation.

Materials: Full printed participant guide included.

WHO IS THIS FOR

This workshop is designed for professionals and leaders in organisations where decisions carry real consequences.

- Managers and team leaders responsible for strategy and execution
- Professionals in analysis, consulting, finance, or operations roles
- HR and learning teams building critical thinking capability at scale
- Executive teams preparing for complex decisions or major change
- Any professional who has felt the cost of a decision made too fast

WHAT YOU LEAVE WITH

Specific tools, not abstract principles. Participants complete an individual action plan before leaving.

- A working vocabulary for evaluating reasoning quality in proposals and meetings
- The R.E.D. Model, the Paul-Elder Framework, and First Principles applied to real cases
- A personal blind spot identified and named
- Six Socratic question types ready to use in the next team meeting
- One specific critical thinking commitment with an accountability partner

THE APPROACH

Training changes behavior only when it connects to the actual problems participants are facing. Every exercise in this workshop is designed to surface real examples from the group — not hypothetical case studies.

“The first principle is that you must not fool yourself — and you are the easiest person to fool.”

Richard P. Feynman, Physicist and Nobel Laureate

DANIEL STAMIN



Twenty-five years of business experience across oil and gas, pharma, FMCG, finance, and a dozen other industries. Management consultant, trainer, coach. Probably overqualified to help you, definitely invested in doing it well.

I spent 14 years training people in behavioral and leadership skills before I understood that the hardest skill is knowing when to stop pushing and start listening. That realization is more or less what made me a coach.

Over 1,000 hours of one-to-one and team coaching since 2015. I bring the structure of a consultant, the patience of a trainer, and the self-awareness of a recovering perfectionist who is still very much in recovery.

MY CREDENTIALS



Professional Certified Coach (PCC)
International Coaching Federation
ICF Certified since 2018



Certified Practitioner in Team Coaching
Global Team Coaching Institute (GTCI)
Issued January 2022

**Certified Practitioner
in Team Coaching**



NLP Master Practitioner
International Association for Neuro-Linguistic Programming (IANLP)
Issued June 2019

BOOK THIS TRAINING

The first step is a scoping conversation. We discuss your group's context, the specific challenges you want to address, and whether a standard or customised version of the workshop fits best. No cost. No commitment.

Reach us at contact@grundimpuls.com